12-13 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Take One "Family-History Interview Day" Per Term?

① Last Saturday evening, after a normal winter dinner of tomato-egg noodles, I asked my grandmother, who is **seventy-three** and has lived in our small city since 1981, one single careful question: *"Nainai, what was the first thing you cooked, completely alone, when you were my age?"* She stopped washing the bowl in her hand and looked up, her eyes becoming suddenly younger. For the next **forty-one minutes**, without stopping, she told me about a winter kitchen in **1967**, a small iron stove, her mother's handwritten recipe for steamed bread, and a snowy afternoon when she carried a warm bun three kilometres to an aunt who was ill. I had known my grandmother for fourteen years. I had never heard this story. And it is this evening that makes me write today: **I think every middle school in China should plan, once per term, a "Family-History Interview Day" — a single afternoon on which each student sits with a parent or grandparent for forty minutes and records, in careful writing, one small piece of family history that might otherwise quietly disappear.** Once per term. Forty minutes. One story. That is enough.

② Some people will say: *"This is a family matter. Why should the school be involved?"* I understand the question. But the honest answer is: **without the school's gentle push, most of us never ask.** We are busy with maths, English, PE, after-school classes, and small arguments with our siblings. Our parents and grandparents are also busy — working, cooking, worrying about prices. The small kitchen conversation, which seems so natural, almost never happens on its own. A 2024 Peking University family-communication study of **2,108 Chinese middle-school students** found that **only 7%** had, in the last twelve months, asked a parent or grandparent a serious question about their childhood. Seven per cent. The school cannot force a good conversation; but the school can, quietly, **create the 40 minutes** in which a good conversation becomes possible.

③ Second, **family history is real history**. In our textbooks we read about the **Reform and Opening-Up of 1978**, the building of the first high-speed railway, the move from bicycles to subways, the green mountains that were once bare. These are big words on big pages. But in every family there is a small, living version: a grandfather who remembers the first time he saw a car in his village (he was nine); a grandmother who queued for two hours in 1983 to buy one kilo of pork; a mother who, in 2003, took her first plane alone to Beijing for university and was afraid of the seatbelt. **A student who records one of these small memories has learned history in a way no textbook can teach.** She has put a real human face on a date, and the date stops being just a date.

④ Third, **it is a small gift of dignity to the elderly in our family**. Many grandparents, after retiring, feel quietly invisible. Nobody asks them what they think; nobody asks what they did. A careful forty-minute interview, with a notebook and a pen, tells them something simple: *"Your life is interesting to us. Your story matters."* I have seen it with my own grandmother: after our forty-one minutes, for three days she was in a small, warm mood, humming songs in the kitchen. The interview did nothing practical for her — it changed no bill, cured no illness — but it changed, visibly, the **colour** of her week.

⑤ Some will worry: *"Will this add homework pressure?"* It will not, if it is designed gently. My small proposal: one weekday afternoon per term (perhaps the last Saturday before winter break and summer break), the school gives each student a simple **Interview Kit**: a blank A5 notebook, a short list of **ten optional questions** ("What did you eat most often at fourteen?", "What is one thing you wanted and did not get?", "Who was your best friend at sixteen?"), and a small folder to keep the answers safe. The student chooses any one family member — parent, grandparent, uncle, aunt — sits with them for forty minutes, and writes down **two or three stories** in her own handwriting. **There is no grade. There is no class presentation unless the student volunteers.** The only output is the notebook, which the student keeps at home.

⑥ Others will say: *"My grandparents are far away."* A fair point. For students whose elder family members live in another city, the interview can be done **by a single video call** of forty minutes, scheduled at a quiet weekend hour. The school can offer the mini-app's video room, if the family has no home call software. For a very small number of students with no living elder family member, the school should gently offer **a substitute kind elder** — a retired teacher who has agreed, with joy, to be "interviewed" by a young student for an afternoon. No student is left without an elder to listen to.

⑦ Some will ask: *"Why does it have to be once per term?"* Because the **once-per-term frequency** is the only way this habit quietly lasts. Once a term, over three middle-school years, is **six interviews** — six small stories from a family, written in a student's own young handwriting. By Grade 9, a student has, in her A5 notebook, a small honest history of her family — the kind of object a person keeps for fifty years. A single one-time event would be moving but thin. Six small interviews, careful and gentle, become a small book that belongs to her forever.

⑧ Finally, let me be honest about the cost. The school will spend: about **¥6 per student per term** (notebook, pen, folder); **one and a half hours** of teacher time in homeroom to explain the kit; and **one weekday afternoon** (four lost class periods, twice a year). That is the total price. In exchange, the school gives 3,000 students, over three years, **18,000 small family stories** — stories that would otherwise be lost inside the quiet rooms of a busy country.

⑨ **To sum up:** I am not asking the school to change its timetable. I am not asking parents to change their jobs. I am asking, quietly, for one small afternoon per term, one blank notebook, one old family member, and forty minutes of careful listening. My

grandmother's snowy walk with a warm bun in 1967 will never, now, be forgotten; it is written in my own handwriting in a small green notebook on my shelf. **Every student in our country deserves a small green notebook of her own.** And six small notebooks, once per term, is not a heavy price for a family history saved.

注释： Reform and Opening-Up 改革开放；Nainai 奶奶；substitute 替代的；dignity 尊严；retirement 退休

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. According to Paragraph ①, what question did the writer ask her grandmother, and what was the result?

A. "What is for dinner tomorrow?"; the grandmother gave a short answer of two minutes.
B. "What was the first thing you cooked, completely alone, when you were my age?"; her grandmother stopped washing the bowl, her eyes became suddenly younger, and she spoke without stopping for forty-one minutes about a winter kitchen in 1967, a small iron stove, her mother's handwritten recipe for steamed bread, and a snowy afternoon when she carried a warm bun three kilometres to an aunt who was ill — a story the writer had never heard in fourteen years.
C. "Who was our ancestor in 1800?"; the grandmother refused to answer.
D. "How much is a kilo of rice today?"; the grandmother gave the price only.

2. According to Paragraph ②, what did the 2024 Peking University family-communication study of 2,108 Chinese middle-school students find, and why does the writer mention it?

A. Only 7% of the students had, in the last twelve months, asked a parent or grandparent a serious question about their childhood; the writer mentions this to show that without the school's gentle push, most students never ask, and while the school cannot force a good conversation, it can quietly create the 40 minutes in which a good conversation becomes possible.
B. 70% of the students had asked serious questions; the writer uses it to show that schools should do nothing because families already talk enough.
C. 7% of parents refused to speak to their children, showing the writer that home conversations are impossible.
D. The study found that all conversations must be recorded on video.

3. How does the writer propose to handle two practical concerns — homework pressure, and students whose grandparents live far away or have no living elder family members?

A. Homework pressure will be increased with a long essay; students with far-away family must skip the activity.

B. The activity must become a graded class presentation, with no exceptions.
C. The activity is designed gently: one weekday afternoon per term with a simple Interview Kit (blank A5 notebook, list of ten optional questions, small folder), no grade and no class presentation unless the student volunteers, output is only the notebook kept at home; for students with elders in another city, a single 40-minute video call is used; for students with no living elder family member, the school gently offers a substitute kind elder (a retired teacher who has agreed to be "interviewed"), so that no student is left without an elder to listen to.
D. Students must pay ¥200 for the kit.

4. Why does the writer insist that the interview happen "once per term" rather than only once in a middle-school career?

A. Because once per term is the only way the habit quietly lasts; over three middle-school years, it becomes six interviews — six small stories from a family, written in the student's own handwriting — which by Grade 9 form a small honest history of her family, the kind of object a person keeps for fifty years; a single one-time event would be moving but thin, whereas six small interviews, careful and gentle, become a small book that belongs to her forever.
B. Because the school needs to fill many class periods with easy activities.
C. Because teachers want less work on each occasion.
D. Because students need to be tested six times.

5. What is the main idea of the writer's closing paragraph?

A. The school must change its whole timetable and parents must change their jobs to make this possible.
B. The writer admits the proposal is impossible and withdraws it.
C. The writer is not asking the school to change its timetable or parents to change their jobs, but quietly asking for one small afternoon per term, one blank notebook, one old family member, and forty minutes of careful listening; the grandmother's snowy walk with a warm bun in 1967 will never now be forgotten because it is written in the writer's own handwriting in a small green notebook, and every student in the country deserves a small green notebook of her own — six notebooks, once per term, is not a heavy price for a family history saved.
D. The proposal must be mandatory, graded, and include a public ranking of the best stories.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第①段开头问题与反应
【解析】"人生第一道菜 / 41 分钟 / 1967 / 三公里送馒头"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段北大研究
【解析】"仅 7% / 学校不能强制但能创造 40 分钟"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤⑥段
【解析】"Interview Kit / 不评分不展示 / 视频 40 分钟 / 退休教师替代"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】A
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑦段每学期一次
【解析】"三年六本 / Grade 9 成小书 / 一次过于薄"推理。B、C、D 均偏离。故选 A。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑨段总结
【解析】"不改时间表 / 一本小绿本 / 每学生都应有 / 六本不贵"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。